Data Structures and Algorithms: Assessment

Imperial College Business School, Business Analytics

Grade breakdown

Component	Weight
Exam	80%
Homework 1	5%
Homework 2	10%
Participation (class-by-class activity)	5%

Participation

Most classes include a short activity, marked for correctness: that is, we check whether the Python functions you write behave correctly on a range of inputs, not how polished your code looks. It's due about a week after the respective class. See the separate **Submission Instructions** document for the current submission mechanism.

Optional case studies

Each class also includes a real-world case study. These are for practice only: they are not submitted or graded. Some may be used for our tutorial classes.

Homeworks

Two individual homework assignments recap, explore, and combine ideas from across the module. They're marked for correctness in the same way as the class activities. Due dates are on Canvas.

Exam

The exam takes place in December, covering both theoretical questions and writing Python code on a computer. A mock exam is made available toward the end of the module. Exact date and logistics are communicated by the exams team.

Collaboration guidelines

We strongly encourage you to discuss course materials and activities with your classmates: that's both a great way to learn and more fun than working alone.

The limit of this cooperation is the **homework assignments and the exam**, which must be your own work. In brief, you should not:

- Copy code from classmates, or let others see your code
- Look for solutions online, or post your own solutions online

You may use Generative AI tools on the homeworks the same way we discussed in Class 1: as a coach and collaborator for building understanding, not as a shortcut past learning. You still need to be able to explain and defend the code you submit.

The College takes plagiarism very seriously; it can result in severe penalties. See Imperial's Academic Integrity policy for details. Our autograding system includes an AI-based plagiarism detection service that checks submissions against both peer work and public sources; any detected misconduct is investigated and can lead to disciplinary action.